

Tobias Treppmann

Design Engineer — design the decision in running code, against real data

LOCATION Berlin, Germany

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PROFILE

I design in Figma and decide in code. At Bibel TV I prototype against real production APIs and engineering ships from that code. The design system underneath is mine: DTCG tokens in four tiers, with CI checks that refuse off-system work. The problem I keep returning to is human-agent interfaces: giving an agent context and staying upstream of the send.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web, connected TV) Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- The design decision gets made in running code. I prototype the product against real APIs, web first then Android, and engineering ships from that code.
- A color engine, and the tool that tunes it. Both live in production. K-means clustering in OKLCH rather than RGB, so themes carry perceptual weight.
- Human-agent interfaces, shipped. An AI support copilot in production for viewer services, drafting in the handbook's wording. A restricted-topic list sits in the system prompt, and every send decision stays human.
- Design system as an API: DTCG tokens in four tiers, built with Style Dictionary to serve iOS, Android, web and connected TV from one source. Built without a platform team.
- The tickets are mine to write. I spec and prioritize what engineering works from, and check the built feature rather than calling it done at handoff.
- No in-house design team, so I own UI quality and consistency across iOS, Android, web and connected TV, with nobody to delegate it to. Product managers and product owners build day to day, and an external engineering agency ships from my prototype code across a company boundary.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Extended the platform instead of adding to it. Booking built on the existing calendar and form builder, not as a standalone module, so one build covered room rentals and weddings too.
- Three stakeholder groups with opposing needs on one surface: funeral directors, parish assistants and priests.
- A scheduling mistake in that workflow is not a minor inconvenience.
- Two engineers, two months, daily contact. Design in Figma, build in code, and I was in the build every day rather than at the end of it.
- Accessibility met by the product. An EU accessibility law landed on churches whose sites the platform hosts; we shipped what met it automatically, six countries, under GDPR plus church law.

Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) Berlin, Germany

- On Ninox's Senior Leadership Team, with 5 direct reports including a design lead. I owned the design system there and established joint governance with engineering.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Executive-level mandate in a 100+-person shared-services organization. Partnered with the executive team to productize the service organization. Case-by-case support became a standard catalog.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Five years of data-dense B2B interfaces. Big-data pivot tables, column charts, aggregated JSON views, result cards and filter logic. Necessary complexity kept, weight kept off.
- Research inside institutions that make users hard to reach. Pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to get to analysts working inside banks and insurers.
- The platform operated under HIPAA compliance among other frameworks.
- Design system. I defined component behavior and specs across the library.
- Functional head, two direct reports, peer among department heads under a VP of Design. Led the design team across Germany and NYC throughout.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Design Consultant · *Ninox Software GmbH* · Summer 2025 · freelance · prompt-to-database AI onboarding

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2008 – 2009 · Düsseldorf, Germany

Freelance Web Designer · 2003 – 2008 · Düsseldorf, Germany

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2000 – 2003 · Düsseldorf, Germany

E-Commerce Assistant · *Westfalia Werkzeugcompany* · 1999 · Hagen, Germany

EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA

Completed 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland

2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

How I Work in Code

Prototyped in real code against real production APIs, web first then Android · Iteration moved from days of spec-and-handoff to hours in working code · Engineering at Bibel TV is an external agency, so that handoff crosses a company boundary and holds anyway · The honest split: HTML, CSS and some JavaScript by hand, everything else agentic · I direct the model rather than typing the framework, and I would rather say so now than have you find it in week tw · Claude Code, Claude Projects and Claude skills as daily tools, plus Zed · Figma and Figma Variables · HTML, CSS, JavaScript · SwiftUI · Storybook · Dovetail and usertesting.com · “Designing with and for AI” workshop series run since 2024 with a partner agency

Color, Contrast and Visual Systems

Built Bibel TV’s color engine and the tool that configures it, both live in production · K-means clustering in OKLCH rather than RGB, so themes carry even perceptual weight across a grid instead of some cards demanding the page and others disappearing · Low-vibrance clusters filtered so a muddy beige cannot win by covering the most pixels · Text validated against base with the WCAG algorithm, lightness and chroma adjusted until the pair passes, so no theme ships failing · Every threshold a dial in the config tool, no commit needed

Human-Agent Interfaces

A support copilot live in production, where the person stays upstream of the send · Restricted topics named in an explicit restricted-topic list in the system prompt and the draft suppressed entirely when the input is not a viewer enquiry · Prompt-to-database onboarding at Ninox, where the generated schema renders into the real editor rather than a chat preview, so it can be inspected and corrected instead of accepted blind · An AI fundraising ecosystem built solo end to end, from analysis through prompt architecture and prototype to a production skill

Dense Enterprise Workflows

Fifteen years of complex B2B software · Five years of data-dense B2B interfaces at Datameer — pivot tables, column charts, aggregated JSON views, result cards, filter logic · The query-builder preview, where the result is a sample and the interface has to say so without becoming unreadable · Three stakeholder groups with opposing needs on one ChurchDesk surface, in a workflow where a scheduling mistake is not a minor inconvenience · Analysts inside top US, Canadian and UK banks and insurers, reached through screening built for institutions that had never granted research access

Design Systems as Infrastructure

Design system as an API at Bibel TV: DTCG tokens in four tiers (primitives, semantic, component, page and view), built with Style Dictionary and platform-agnostic, serving iOS, Android, web and connected TV from one source · One commit propagates to every platform that consumes it, which is what makes the high-quality choice the fast one · Governance run as a cross-functional working group with assigned members and an escalation path · Defined component behavior and specs across the Datameer design system, with UI executing the visual system · Accessibility shipped under regulation rather than advocated · Responsive and mobile-first across web, iOS, Android and connected TV

Where I Have Led

Team of five including a design lead at Ninox, on the Senior Leadership Team · Product management and all of product design held together at ChurchDesk · Design team across Germany and NYC for five years at Datameer · Listed last on purpose — this application is for the work, not the title